

לכאורה, to my mind, the first שבעה that was ever alluded to in the Torah is in פרשת חיי שרה. שרה passed away, and it says (23:2) וַתָּמָת שָׂרָה, and the next פסוק says וַיָּקָם אַבְרָהָם מֵעַל פְּנֵי מֶתוֹ. So what does it mean וַיָּקָם? It means he got up from שבעה.

The famous קאפיטל we say in תהלים of למנצה has within it a pasuk (תהילים מ"ט:י"ז): אַל תִּירָא כִּי יַעֲשֶׂר אִישׁ כִּי - Don't be afraid if a person is wealthy, that the כבוד, the honor of his house, has become magnified; וְיָרָקָה כְּבוֹד בֵּיתוֹ - As they say in English, "You can't take it with you." In Yiddish they say, "There are no pockets in תכריכים." - לא ירד אַחֲרָיו כְּבוֹדוֹ - His כבוד will not go down.

Rabbi Oelbaum, quoting the Satmar Rebbe זצ"ל, has a completely different take on this pasuk, which I have used in many, many שבעה calls, and it has been a נחמה for, if not hundreds of people, dozens of people.

אִישׁ - Don't be afraid if a person has עשירות. What after all is עשירות? ריכטיגע עשירות is תורה, עשירות, that is the true עשירות. וְיָרָקָה כְּבוֹד בֵּיתוֹ - that his house has become magnified, that's a תורה'דיגע house, a שטיב full of Torah, full of people who are following in the footsteps of their עלטערן. וְיָקָה הַכֹּל - the מיתה cannot take that away from you, exact opposite of how we טייטשט פשוט פשוט. The מיתה cannot possibly hurt that. - לא ירד אַחֲרָיו כְּבוֹדוֹ - the כבוד will not go down, the כבוד will go up with the person.

It's a tremendous נחמה for a person to hear such a word, that he knows that he is carrying on the tradition, the מסורה of the one who has passed away, and that מסורה will be ongoing as a שלשלת, as a link in the chain until ביאת גואל צדק במהרה בימינו אמן.

